

vein. In 1904, he became a pupil of Schoenberg, who guided his evolution toward atonal music. Webern's grief at the death of his mother in 1906 found expression in the powerful *Six Pieces for Orchestra*, first performed at the infamous "Scandal Concert" in Vienna in 1913, in which the audience rioted because of the music's experimentalism. As a member of the Schoenberg-led Second Viennese School, in the 1920s Webern adopted 12-tone serial technique, but his style was idiosyncratic in its compression, brevity, and elusive beauty. From 1922 to 1934, he conducted a workers' orchestra in Vienna. In his later years, he lived a withdrawn life, loving nature and devoted to his wife and four children. He was shot dead by a US soldier during the Allied occupation of Austria in 1945.

KEY WORKS: *Six Pieces for Orchestra*, Op. 6, 1910; *Six Bagatelles* (string quartet), Op. 9, 1913; *Variations for piano*, Op. 27, 1936; *Cantata No. 1*, Op. 29, 1939

Alban Berg

1885–1935, AUSTRIAN

A member of the Second Viennese School, Berg used Modernist composition techniques to create emotion-